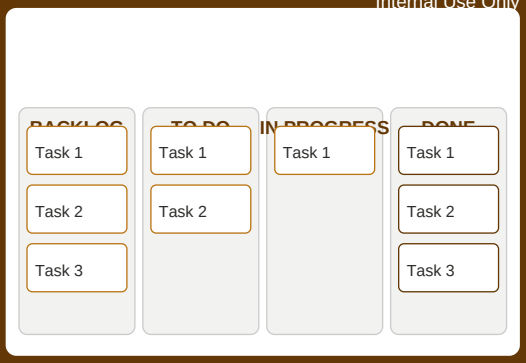
OPERATIONS

Kanban

Control inventory and workflow using visual signals — cards, bins, or board columns — that trigger replenishment only



WHEN TO USE

To replace push scheduling with a demand-driven pull system; to make work in progress visible and strictly limited.

HOW TO APPLY — STEPS

1. Analyse consumption rate and replenishment lead time for each item
2. Calculate the required kanban quantity for each part or task
3. Design the trigger mechanism — physical card, empty bin, or board column
4. Train all users thoroughly before launch
5. Review and adjust kanban quantities regularly as demand patterns change

PRACTITIONER TIP

! Start with too many kanbans and reduce them gradually over weeks. Starting with too few causes stoppages on day one.

KEY OUTPUTS

- Kanban design specification
- Physical or digital kanban system
- WIP reduction trend chart

HOW TO MEASURE SUCCESS

WIP reduction %; stockout frequency per week; inventory value reduction

TOOL CATEGORY
Operations